CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 5: **Universal Franchise and India's Electoral System** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A coalition government is formed when 1

(a) elections are cancelled
(b) President rules
(c) no party has a clear majority and parties unite
(d) one party has all seats

2. A leader's hate speech during campaign violates 1

(a) the Census **(b)** NOTA
(c) the Model Code of Conduct **(d)** the Rajya Sabha rules

3. A person nominated by the President to the Rajya Sabha for expertise 1

(a) can vote **(b)** is elected
(c) cannot vote in the Presidential election **(d)** must resign

4. A question: why has India not used proxy voting to include all? Best answer 1

(a) It is cheap
(b) It is mandated
(c) It is popular
(d) It threatens secrecy and equality of vote

5. Why is a free press important during elections? 1

(a) It informs voters on candidates and issues
(b) It collects tax
(c) It blocks voting
(d) It chooses winners

6. A government announces a big new scheme the day before polls. Which rule is violated? 1

(a) Model Code of Conduct **(b)** Article 14
(c) FPTP **(d)** NOTA

7. The Election Commission can postpone polling in a booth if 1

(a) candidates ask
(b) rain
(c) party wishes
(d) there is serious disturbance or malpractice

8. Why are electoral reforms continuing? 1

(a) Courts forbid them **(b)** Parties ban them
(c) New challenges keep emerging **(d)** Elections are perfect

9. **Assertion (A):** The Rajya Sabha is a permanent House. 1
Reason (R): All its members retire together every five years.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Nominated members of the Rajya Sabha vote in the Presidential election. 1
Reason (R): The President is elected by an Electoral College of the elected members of Parliament and State Assemblies.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is the Election Commission's neutrality necessary? 2

12. Why are Rajya Sabha elections indirect? 2

13. What does a rise in NOTA votes signal? 2

14. Why would a poll tax contradict universal franchise? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Case: A booth is far from a village and the elderly cannot reach it. Suggest three solutions. 3

16. Examine why India holds elections for local bodies separately. 3

17. Assess whether EVMs have improved elections. 3

OR

Argue whether NOTA should lead to re-election. 3

18. Interpret the figure: about 3.1 million elected representatives in local bodies. 3

OR

Case: A candidate threatens voters. What action should the ECI take? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Out of the 543 Lok Sabha constituencies, 84 are reserved for Scheduled Castes and 47 for Scheduled Tribes. The Rajya Sabha has 245 members, of whom 12 are nominated by the President from fields such as arts, science, literature and social service. 5
(i) How many Lok Sabha seats are reserved for Scheduled Castes?
(ii) How many are reserved for Scheduled Tribes?
(iii) How many Rajya Sabha members are nominated by the President?
(iv) Why are some constituencies reserved?

20. Compare the electoral systems used for the Lok Sabha, the Rajya Sabha and the President. 5

OR

Evaluate the argument that indirect elections are suitable for certain offices. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks